

PaleoPrairie Museum

Our Story

Our museum began with a simple but powerful idea: to keep the fossils of western Kansas *in* western Kansas. Nestled in a region rich with prehistoric history, we are committed to uncovering, preserving, and showcasing the ancient life that once roamed our land.

It all started when a local dig site uncovered a nearly complete fossilized skeleton of a marine reptile, and rather than see it shipped out of state, a small team of paleontology enthusiasts and community members worked together to find a way to preserve it locally. From that effort grew a mission to support fossil digs in western Kansas and build a place where discoveries stay rooted in the land they were found.

Today, our museum proudly funds archaeological digs, preserves rare fossils, and tells the story of Kansas' ancient life—from the inland sea to the towering dinosaurs that left their mark here millions of years ago.

Western Kansas Dinosaur Museum: Nine Questions

- 1. What is your primary objective for this website?**
To educate, engage, and inspire curiosity about the prehistoric life of western Kansas. We want visitors to learn about our digs, see fossil preparation in action, and explore our collection. We also aim to raise funds for future digs and preservation efforts.
- 2. Who will be the audience of this website?**
Our visitors include families, students, teachers, fossil enthusiasts, paleontologists, tourists, and supporters of Kansas history. We also engage with donors, volunteers, and community members who want to support local science and education.
- 3. Do you have the content ready for this website?**
Yes, we have a library of fossil photographs, images from our dig sites, and detailed descriptions of our current exhibits. We're gathering personal stories from our volunteer dig crews and working on behind-the-scenes videos of fossil restoration.
- 4. Have you created a list of keywords for search engine optimization?**
Not yet, but we know important terms will include: "Kansas fossils," "western Kansas dinosaurs," "paleontology museum," "family-friendly attractions Kansas,"

“fossil digs Kansas,” and “local science museum.”

5. Are you an established brand?

We’re growing quickly. While we’re still a relatively young museum, we’re well-known in regional science and education circles. Our community outreach events, fossil fairs, and dig site tours have built a loyal base of supporters. Our logo and branding are consistent across signage, merch, and social media.

6. Are you prepared for further investments after the website is launched?

Yes. We know the site will need regular updates for events, new discoveries, educational resources, and fundraising campaigns. We also plan to add a virtual tour feature and an e-commerce section for merchandise and donations.

7. Who are your competitors?

Rather than compete, we collaborate with other museums, universities, and educational organizations. What sets us apart is our commitment to keeping Kansas fossils in Kansas, and our emphasis on hands-on learning and local involvement.

8. Have you planned a promotion strategy to get more visitors?

We are in the early stages. We hope to use social media, local tourism guides, school outreach, and fossil-themed events to promote our site. We’d love help creating a comprehensive launch and promotion plan.

9. What adjectives would you use to describe your museum?

Curious, local, authentic, hands-on, and passionate—just like the explorers and scientists we hope to inspire.

CURRENT EXHIBITS:

1. Sea Monsters of the Kansas Inland Sea

Description:

Step back in time 80 million years when western Kansas was underwater. Explore life in the Western Interior Seaway with fossil specimens of mosasaurs, plesiosaurs, and giant ammonites. Interactive displays show how these marine reptiles hunted, lived, and ruled the ancient sea.

Highlight Fossils:

- *Tylosaurus* skull
 - *Plesiosaur* flipper bones
 - Ammonite spiral shells
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2. Prairie Giants: Dinosaurs of the High Plains

Description:

Discover the land-dwelling dinosaurs that roamed Kansas when the waters receded. Learn about the climate and vegetation that supported these animals, and see full skeletal reconstructions of local species.

Highlight Fossils:

- *Niobrerasaurus coleii* (an armored dinosaur unique to Kansas)
 - Hadrosaur limb bones
 - Fossilized dinosaur tracks and coprolites (dino poop!)
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3. The Dig: Unearthing the Past

Description:

Go behind the scenes of a real paleontological excavation in western Kansas. This exhibit features tools, photos, and interactive stations where guests can simulate digging and preparing fossils just like our field teams do.

Special Features:

- **Real fossils from recent digs**
- **Time-lapse of fossil cleaning and preservation**
- **Volunteer shout-outs and stories from the field**